

ITA to PR: The 11-Step Roadmap

The end-to-end path from the day your Invitation to Apply arrives to the day you land in Canada - what happens at each step, what can slow it down, and what to do about it.

Step 1 - Day 0 - The ITA arrives

The invitation appears in your online account and your 60-day clock starts. The invitation is valid for 60 days only - no extensions. Confirm immediately that everything in your profile is still true; you will be assessed against what you claimed.

Step 2 - Days 0-3 - Accept the mission, audit the claim

Re-verify your CRS inputs before doing anything else: age band, language results still under 2 years old at submission, ECA still under 5 years old, work history exactly as documented. If your score was inflated by an error, declining the ITA keeps you in the pool; submitting an inaccurate application risks refusal or a misrepresentation finding.

Step 3 - Days 0-7 - Order every police certificate

One for you and each family member 18+, from every country stayed in for 6 consecutive months or longer during the last 10 years. Some countries take months - order everything in week one. If a certificate will not arrive in time, keep dated proof that you requested it.

Step 4 - Days 3-10 - Book the medical exam

Book an immigration medical exam with an IRCC panel physician - only panel physicians count. IRCC advises taking the exam as close as possible to the date you apply. You will receive an information printout or IMM 1017B form to upload. All family members need exams, including those not accompanying you.

Step 5 - Days 3-14 - Lock the employment evidence

Collect reference letters for every position you claimed points for: letterhead, dates, 5+ duties matching your NOC, hours, salary, signatory contact details, company stamp. This is the most common failure point in the entire system - get it right before uploading anything.

Step 6 - Days 7-21 - Assemble proof of funds

FSWP/FSTP: official bank letter + 6 months of statements showing a stable balance above the current canada.ca threshold for your family size (updated annually - check the live table). CEC applicants and valid job-offer holders upload an exemption letter instead. Any recent large deposit needs a documented source and an explanation letter.

Step 7 - Days 14-40 - Complete the e-APR and upload

Fill the online application form and work through your personalized document checklist: civil status certificates, birth certificates for dependants, translations (certified translator or affidavit + original), IMM 5409 if common-law, IMM 5476 if represented. Write a Letter of Explanation for anything an officer could find inconsistent.

Step 8 - Days 40-55 - Final audit, pay, submit

Cross-check every date against every document, confirm each upload slot, pay the processing and right-of-PR fees listed at canada.ca, and submit before day 60. Do not use the full window if you can avoid it - a buffer absorbs surprises (a rejected photo, a missing page, a certificate that needs re-issuing).

Step 9 - After submission - AOR and biometrics

You receive an Acknowledgment of Receipt (AOR). If asked, give biometrics (fingerprints + photo) at a collection point after paying the biometrics fee. IRCC then verifies your information and you can track status in your account.

Step 10 - Processing - stay ready, stay consistent

IRCC may request additional documents at any point - respond fast and keep every document consistent with what you filed. Update IRCC if your family status changes. Check current processing times on the canada.ca

processing-times tool rather than relying on anecdotes.

Step 11 - Decision - COPR and landing

On approval you receive a Confirmation of Permanent Residence (COPR) and, if from a visa-required country, a PR visa. Check every detail on the COPR for errors, then complete landing - at a port of entry or virtually as instructed - before your COPR expiry. Your PR card follows by mail. Welcome to Canada.

If a step is delayed

If any single document cannot arrive inside the 60 days: upload dated proof that you ordered it, plus a Letter of Explanation. If your medical cannot be booked in time, document the earliest available appointment. Officers work with applicants who show diligence - silence and blank slots get files refused.

Sources

Every rule and figure in this document was verified against the following official pages on 19 July 2026:

- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/apply-permanent-residence.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/after-apply.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/application-approved.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/police-certificates.html
- canada.ca/en/immigration-refugees-citizenship/services/immigrate-canada/express-entry/documents/proof-funds.html

Important - please read

The information provided is for informational and guidance purposes only, based on publicly available Immigration, Refugees and Citizenship Canada (IRCC) regulations and policies. This does not constitute legal advice, and no solicitor-client or consultant-client relationship is created by accessing this content. Immigration regulations, program requirements, processing times, and CRS cutoff scores are subject to frequent change without notice. You are responsible for verifying all information with official IRCC sources (www.canada.ca/immigration) and confirming current eligibility requirements before taking any action.